THE SIAR MODULE

Sessions 6, 7, and 8 · LAW 575 · Spring 2027 · Professor Haque

Three sessions in this course are about how government makes internet law: how a statute is enacted, how an agency writes rules and brings enforcement actions under it, and how a court reviews what the agency did. The block also carries the Law School's Statutory Interpretation and Agency Regulation requirement, so every student completes a graded exercise in it. This document says what happens in each session, what the quiz asks, and how the work is assessed.

Session 6: The Module

Before class: the SIAR prep set. Read the COPPA packet posted on Canvas: the statute at 15 U.S.C. §§ 6501-6505 and the FTC's rule at 16 C.F.R. §§ 312.1-312.5 and 312.9 (§ 6506 and the rest of Part 312 are COPPA too and worth reading, but not required for the set; the packet's only true neighbors, Chapter 91A and Parts 311 and 313, are not assigned). Then submit four one-line notes as an individual Canvas annotation on the PDF, each anchored to a sentence: the grant (where Congress tells the FTC to make rules, and how wide the grant is); the addition (one place where the rule says something the statute does not, and what the agency added); the hinge (one statutory phrase whose meaning the rule had to settle, and who decided what it means); and the enforcement (who enforces, under what authority, and what a violation is treated as). This is a Canvas annotation, not a Hypothesis set, and it is part of the SIAR block rather than one of the course's annotation sets. Work it without AI: AI anywhere in the SIAR block is an Honor Code matter. You will meet each of your four notes again in class, as a belt. The prep set is due by 1:15 pm on Monday, February 1, the start of Session 6; after that it is a late item, which counts toward the participation Honors limit under the syllabus's late-work rule.

In class. You work through an interactive module, Gears, Belts, and Blocks, that teaches the machinery of administrative law through a mechanical analogy, and you complete its required practice problems. If you miss Session 6, or do not finish in class, complete the practice problems at home by 1:15 pm on Monday, February 8, the start of Session 8; after that they are a late item, which counts toward the participation Honors limit under the syllabus's late-work rule, and the block closes at the beginning of Session 9. If Session 6 is your third or fourth absence, it also needs the attendance make-up: watch the recording and post a synthesis to the Session Make-Up Board (see the syllabus). As a first or second absence it is automatically excused, but the practice problems are still owed. Work them without AI: AI anywhere in the SIAR block is an Honor Code matter.

The module's vocabulary is fixed, and the rest of the block uses it:

- **Casing and gear.** Government is one complex machine built of smaller machines. Each government body is a casing; a gear inside it is a working group of people. A company is a gear too.
- **Mesh and shaft.** Mesh is work inside one machine. A shaft is supervision within a branch.
- **Belt.** A belt is a written legal document that crosses a boundary between machines. Four kinds stay distinct: an enabling statute, an appropriation, an agency rule or order, and a state law.
- **Belt width and tag.** Belt width is the scope of the power conferred. A tag on a belt is the standard Congress wrote into it.
- **Spinning, stopped, wobbling.** Power flowing, power blocked, and power exercised on bad reasoning.

Gears, Belts, and Blocks was created by Raina Haque. © 2026 Raina Haque. Students enrolled in this course may use it for the course; any other use requires her express permission.

Session 7: The Machinery, Worked

Children's privacy is the worked example. Read Chapter 5.G, pp. 434-460, before class, with the COPPA packet you annotated for Session 6 in hand; the session discusses the reading rather than working through it. You read a statute (the Children's Online Privacy Protection Act), the rule the Federal Trade Commission wrote to implement it, and the Commission's enforcement action against Epic Games. Read the enforcement action closely; skim the California Age-Appropriate Design Code Act for its structure and scope.

Come to class able to say, in the module's terms, which belt is which: what Congress conferred and how wide, what the agency added by rule, and what the agency did when it enforced. Post your annotation set as usual.

Session 8: The Quiz

Part A. Required practice items on Canvas. One complete attempt, at any score, is required, and you may take Part A as many times as you like. It opens at Session 6 (Monday, February 1) and closes, like Part B, at the beginning of Session 9. It is there to let you check the machinery against itself until the answers come easily; work it before you write Part B.

Part B. A written problem, started in class with the full period available, closing at the beginning of Session 9. You are given a statute, an agency source issued under it, and a short scenario, and you work them in the sequence printed with the problem: what the statute says, what the agency source adds, what kind of source it is, who decides what the words mean, and what follows for the party in the scenario. Everything you need is printed with the problem; nothing is looked up. Part B is started in class and may be continued outside it until both parts close at the beginning of Session 9. It is open notes. You may not collaborate, and you may not use generative AI on either part of the quiz; ordinary spelling and grammar checking is fine, but drafting features such as Smart Compose or "Help me write" are not. Answer in ordinary legal language, not the module's mechanical vocabulary: translating the machine back into law is what the problem tests.

WHAT THE QUIZ IS, AND IS NOT

- **It is.** A test of whether you can read a statute and an agency source together and say what they require of someone.
- **It is not.** A memory test about administrative law doctrine, and not a research exercise. No outside authority is used or wanted.
- **Reported.** Your written problem is assessed on a three-level rubric, and the level is reported for the Law School's requirement. Part B is the graded exercise for both prongs: it asks you to interpret a statute and the agency source issued under it.

How the Block Is Assessed

- **Pass.** The Session 6 prep set and practice problems, and the Session 8 quiz (one complete attempt at Part A, and Part B), all completed in good faith.
- **Honors Pass.** The top level of the three-level rubric on Part B, published with this document before the semester begins.
- **If you miss Session 8.** Tell me as soon as you can, beforehand if you know. Both parts stay open until the beginning of Session 9, so you take them on your own before they close; doing so is that session's attendance make-up.

The block is one of the five requirements in the syllabus's What Passing Requires box, and the syllabus controls if this document and it ever differ.

Course documents

Each link opens the current version: the Circle Guide from the shared course folder, every other document from the course website. The syllabus is the master document and controls where documents differ.

Syllabus. The master document; it controls where documents differ.

Circle Guide. How the portfolio works, from sign-up to circles, the Memo Rubric, the cure cycle, the CREAC template, and the Circle Letter form.

Memo Coversheet & Certification. The cover materials required with every memo.

Tech Digest Project. Instructions and deadlines, from the first session to the reflection due February 1.

Annotation Guide. What goes in an annotation set.

SIAR Module (this document). The Session 6 module and the quiz instructions.

Course website. The course home page: next class, deadlines, and links to every course document; the Unit Circles page is linked from it.

Shared course folder. Where the Circle Guide lives, always the current version.

Canvas course. Modules, assignments, sign-ups, the Session Make-Up Board, and recordings.

DOCUMENT HISTORY

OPEN IN v7.1 (unresolved items; each resolves in a numbered revision):

- Part B scenario: the statute and agency source for this course's problem, to be chosen.
- Honors Pass: the top level of the Part B rubric, published with this document before the semester begins.
- Part B's printed sequence: the final step wording is set when the problem is written.
- Canvas build: Part A and Part B remain to be built (QTI imports); the prep-set annotation assignment exists (due Feb. 1, 1:15 pm; closes Feb. 10, 1:15 pm).

v7.1 · Oct 19, 2026 · Course documents: every document but the Circle Guide now opens as a PDF from the course website; links updated; a stray link in the appendix removed; no rule changed.

Earlier versions are kept by the professor; the version above is the one in force.